

5.9 There are different approaches to managing water supply, some more sustainable than others.	a. The pros and cons of the techno-fix of hard engineering schemes to include water transfers, mega dams and desalination plants (🌐 water transfers in China).
	b. The value of more sustainable schemes of restoration of water supplies and water conservation (smart irrigation, recycling of water) (🌐 Singapore). (A: contrasting attitudes to water supply)
	c. Integrated drainage basin management for large rivers (🌐 Nile or Colorado) and water sharing treaties and frameworks (United Nations Economic Commission for Europe (UNECE), Water Convention, Helsinki, and the Water Framework Directive and Hydropower, Berlin). (P: role of players in reducing water conflict risk)

Guidance for integrating geographical skills for Topic 5

Quantitative geographical skills must be developed in this topic, including understanding of simple mass balance, unit conversions, and the analysis and presentation of data. Qualitative approaches may be used if appropriate. The following guidance on integrating geographical skills gives suggestions for opportunities to meet these requirements.

These skills are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these skills across any suitable topic area throughout their course of study. *Appendix 1* outlines the full range of geographical skills.

- (1) Use of diagrams showing proportional flows within systems.
- (2) Comparative analysis of river regime annual discharges.
- (3) Analysis and construction of Water Budget graphs.
- (4) Using comparative data, labelling of features of storm hydrographs.
- (5) Use of large database to study the pattern and trends in floods and droughts worldwide.
- (6) Interpretation of synoptic charts and weather patterns, leading to droughts and floods.
- (7) Use of a global map to analyse world water stress and scarcity.
- (8) Interpretation of water poverty indexes using diamond diagrams for countries at different levels of development.
- (9) Identify seasonal variations in the regime of international rivers, such as the Nile and the Mekong and assess impact of existing and potential dams.